Final Action Agenda/Minutes are supplemented by audio and video recordings of the meetings, as well as transcripts. Video recordings of Village Council meetings from June 8, 2016, forward, as well as agendas, staff reports, resolutions, ordinances, and other documents related to the meetings can be viewed online at https://estero-fl.gov/agendas/ at the corresponding meeting date.

**APPROVED BY COUNCIL**
**OCTOBER 7, 2026**

# VILLAGE COUNCIL BUDGET AND SPECIAL MEETING

**Village of Estero Council Chambers**
**9401 Corkscrew Palms Circle**
**Estero, FL 33928**

**September 23, 2026 5:05 p.m.**

## 1. CALL TO ORDER

### INVOCATION

Pastor Grace Brooks Estero Church

### PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

### ROLL CALL

Present: Mayor Joanne Ribble - District 1, Councilmember Jeff Hunt- District 2, Councilmember Jon McLain - District 3, Councilmember Lori Fayhee – District 4, Councilmember Rafael Lopez - District 5, Councilmember Jim Ward - District 6, and Vice Mayor George Zalucki - District 7.

**Also present**
Village Manager Steve Sarkozy, Village Attorney Robert Eschenfelder, Deputy Village Manager Ryan Eggleston, Public Works Director David Willems, Interim Finance Britt Martin (via Teams), Deputy Village Clerk Tammy Duran, and Village Clerk Carol Sacco.

## 2. SECOND PUBLIC BUDGET HEARINGS

**(a)** Resolution No. 2026-25 Adopting Final Millage rate for Fiscal year 2026-2027

A Resolution of the Village Council of the Village of Estero, Lee County, Florida, Adopting the Final Millage Rate for the Levying of Ad Valorem Taxes for the Village of Estero, Lee County, Florida, for Fiscal Year 2026-2027; and Providing an Effective Date.

**Staff Presentation/Comments**
Steve Sarkozy, Village Manager

**Council Questions or Comments**
None

**Public Comments**
None

**Motion**: Motion to adopt Resolution No. 2026-25

**Motion by:** Councilmember McLain
**Seconded by:** Councilmember Lopez

**Action**: Adopted Resolution No. 2026-25

**Vote**: (Roll Call)
Aye: Councilmembers Hunt, McLain, Fayhee, Lopez, Ward, Vice Mayor Zalucki, and Mayor Ribble.
Nay:
Abstentions:

**(b)** Resolution No. 2026-26 Adopting the Final Budget for Fiscal Year 2026-2027

A Resolution of the Village Council of the Village of Estero, Lee County, Florida, Adopting the Final Budget for Fiscal Year 2026-2027; and Providing an Effective Date.

**Staff Presentation/Comments**
Steve Sarkozy, Village Manager

**Council Questions or Comments**
None

**Public Comments**
None

**Motion**: Motion to adopt Resolution No. 2026-26

**Motion by:** Councilmember Ward
**Seconded by:** Councilmember Hunt

**Action**: Adopted Resolution No. 2026-26.

**Vote**: (Roll Call)
Aye: Councilmembers Hunt, McLain, Fayhee, Lopez, Ward, Vice Mayor Zalucki, and Mayor Ribble.
Nay:
Abstentions:

## 3. LETTER OF RECOGNITION

**(a)** Philip Walczak /Estero High School

## 4. APPROVAL OF AGENDA, ADDITIONS, AND DELETIONS

**Motion**: Motion to approve agenda.

**Motion by**: Councilmember Lopez
**Seconded by**: Councilmember Fayhee

**Action**: Approved agenda.

**Vote**: (Roll Call)
Aye: Councilmembers Hunt, McLain, Fayhee, Lopez, Ward, Vice Mayor Zalucki, and Mayor Ribble.
Nay:
Abstentions:

## 5. PUBLIC COMMENT ON NON-AGENDA ITEMS

**eComment**
Denny Sanchez, Estero

## 6. CONSENT AGENDA

**(a)** September 9, 2026 Village Council Meeting Minutes
**(b)** Resolution No. 2026-23 Establishing Meeting Dates, Times, and Location for Meetings of the Village Council for Calendar Year 2027
**(c)** Financial Report for Month ended July 2026

**Motion:** Motion to approve consent agenda.

**Motion by:** Councilmember Lopez
**Seconded by:** Councilmember McLain

**Action:** Approved consent agenda.

**Vote:** (Roll Call)
Aye: Councilmembers Hunt, McLain, Fayhee, Lopez, Ward, Vice Mayor Zalucki, and Mayor Ribble.
Nay:
Abstentions:

## 7. CONSIDERATION OF ITEMS DEFERRED FROM CONSENT AGENDA

None

## 8. ACTION ITEMS

**(a)** Resolution No. 2026-24 – Special Obligation Revenue Bonds, Series 2026

A Resolution of the Village of Estero, Florida Authorizing the Issuance of Not Exceeding $65,000,000 in Aggregate Principal Amount of Village of Estero, Florida Special Obligation Revenue Bonds, Series 2026, in Order to Finance the

Acquisition, Construction and Equipping of Certain Capital Improvements within the Village; Covenanting to Budget and Appropriate Certain Legally Available Non-Ad Valorem Revenues to Pay Debt Service on the Bonds; Providing for the Rights of the Holders of Bonds Issued Hereunder; Authorizing the Awarding of Said Bonds Pursuant to a Public Bid; Delegating Certain Authority to the Village Manager for the Award of the Bonds and the Approval of the Terms and Details of Said Bonds; Authorizing the Publication of a Notice of Sale for the Bonds or a Summary Thereof; Appointing the Paying Agent and Registrar for Said Bonds; Authorizing the Distribution of a Preliminary Official Statement and the Execution and Delivery of an Official Statement with Respect to Such Bonds; Authorizing the Execution and Delivery of a Continuing Disclosure Certificate with Respect to the Bonds and the Appointment of a Dissemination Agent Thereto; and Providing for an Effective Date for this Resolution.

**Staff Presentation/Comments**
Steve Sarkozy, Village Manager
Robert Eschenfelder, Village Attorney

**Council Questions or Comments**
None.

**Public Comments**
None

**Motion:** Motion to adopt Resolution No. 2026-24.

**Motion by:** Councilmember McLain
**Seconded by:** Councilmember Lopez

**Action:** Adopted Resolution No. 2026-24.

**Vote:** (Roll Call)
Aye: Councilmembers Hunt, McLain, Fayhee, Lopez, Ward, Vice Mayor Zalucki, and Mayor Ribble.
Nay:
Abstentions:

**(b)** Bonita Estero Rail Trail (BERT) – First Amendment to Purchase and Sale Agreement

**Staff Presentation/Comments**
Steve Sarkozy, Village Manager
Robert Eschenfelder, Village Attorney

**Council Questions or Comments**
Councilmember Ward, Vice Mayor Zalucki, and Mayor Ribble

**Public Comments**
None

**Motion:** Motion to approve the First Amendment to the Purchase and Sale Agreement between the Village of Estero and The Trust for Public Land for the Bonita Estero Rail Trail (BERT) property, extending the Inspection Period and Closing Date to allow additional time to complete due diligence and coordination for the project and authorize the Village Manager to execute the First Amendment and any additional implementing documents within the scope of the agreement on behalf of the Village of Estero Council.

**Motion by:** Councilmember McLain
**Seconded by:** Councilmember Hunt

**Action:** Approved the First Amendment to the Purchase and Sale Agreement between the Village of Estero and The Trust for Public Land for the Bonita Estero Rail Trail (BERT) property, extending the Inspection Period and Closing Date to allow additional time to complete due diligence and coordination for the project and authorize the Village Manager to execute the First Amendment and any additional implementing documents within the scope of the agreement on behalf of the Village of Estero Council.

**Vote:** (Roll Call)
Aye: Councilmembers Hunt, McLain, Fayhee, Lopez, Ward, Vice Mayor Zalucki, and Mayor Ribble.
Nay:
Abstentions:

**(c)** SportsPark Mowing, Turf, and Athletic Field Maintenance Services

**Staff Presentation/Comments**
Steve Sarkozy, Village Manager

**Council Questions or Comments**
None

**Public Comments**
None

**Motion:** Motion to a approve the FY 2027 task orders with JSM Services, Inc. in a total amount Not to Exceed $161,459 and $17,500 in contingency funding for mowing, turf and athletic field maintenance, clay services, bullpen services, laser grading, and related services at the Estero SportsPark and associated athletic facilities and authorize the Village Manager to sign Task Orders 24024 TO1, TO4 and Task Orders 26022 TO1, TO2, TO3 and other additional implementing documents within the scope of the contracts on behalf of the Village of Estero Council.

**Motion by:** Councilmember Lopez
**Seconded by:** Councilmember Fayhee

**Action:** Approved the FY 2027 task orders with JSM Services, Inc. in a total amount Not to Exceed $161,459 and $17,500 in contingency funding for mowing, turf and athletic field maintenance, clay services, bullpen services, laser grading, and related services at the Estero SportsPark and associated athletic facilities and authorize the Village Manager to sign Task Orders 24024 TO1, TO4 and Task Orders 26022 TO1, TO2, TO3 and other additional implementing documents within the scope of the contracts on behalf of the Village of Estero Council.

**Vote:** (Roll Call)
Aye: Councilmembers Hunt, McLain, Fayhee, Lopez, Ward, Vice Mayor Zalucki, and Mayor Ribble.
Nay:
Abstentions:

## 9. COUNCIL COMMUNICATIONS / FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS

Mayor Ribble.

## 10. VILLAGE ATTORNEY'S REPORT

None

## 11. VILLAGE MANAGER'S REPORT

Steve Sarkozy, Village Manager

**Adjourn Regular Session at 6:04 pm and Convene at 6:04 pm Workshop Item**

## 12. WORKSHOP

**(a)** Broadway Avenue West Roadway Improvements Update

**Staff Presentation/Comments**
Steve Sarkozy, Village Manager
David Willems, Public Works Director

**Presentation/Information by**
Jesse E Gill, P.E, CW3 Engineering, Inc

**Council Questions or Comments**
Councilmembers McLain, Hunt, and Vice Mayor Zalucki

**Public Comments**
Richard Conover, Estero
Brett P. Smith, Estero

**13. ADJOURNMENT at 6:04 pm**

Motion by Councilmember Lopez

ATTEST: VILLAGE OF ESTERO, FLORIDA

By: _____ By: _____

Carol Sacco, CMC, Village Clerk Joanne Ribble, Mayor

(td/CS)

For an official copy of the signed minutes, please submit a Public Record Request.